

Wander 2: public place

1/30/25

"Wandering" is exploring a place (a city, a village, a stretch of nature) without normal directions, and without a plan to go somewhere in particular.

Often a wander will follow a set of rules for how to explore.

This is based on practices originally from SI (situationists) and Debord, but with many many other schools, permutations and traditions

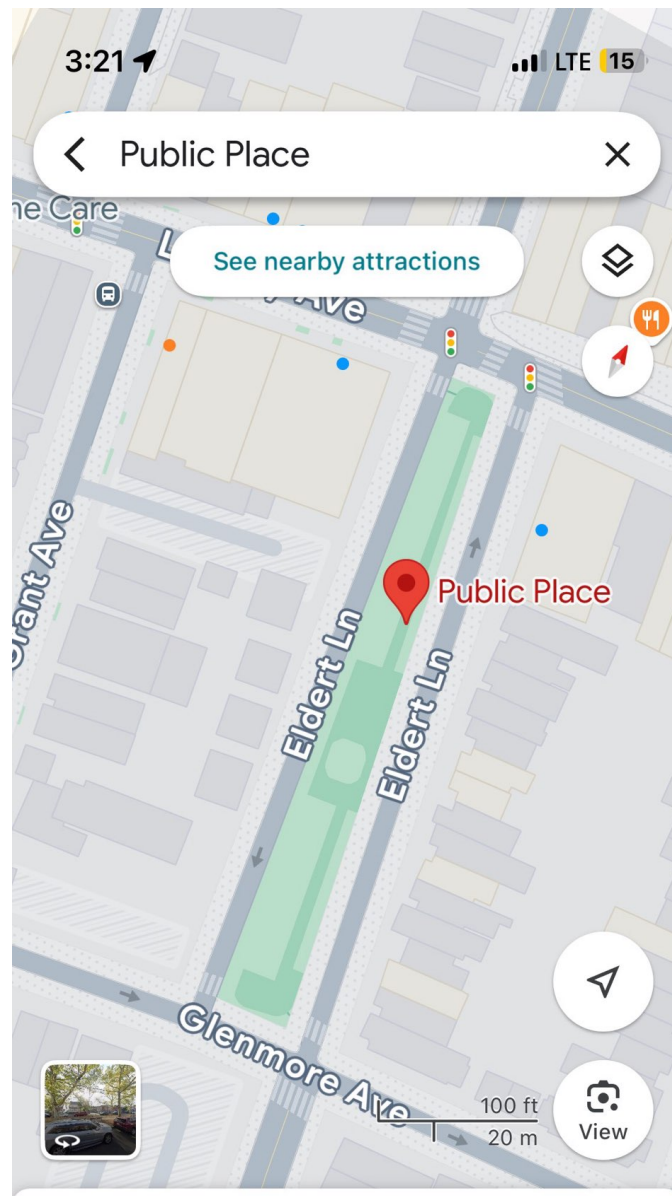
INTRODUCTION

Music is really important to me, maybe the most important thing. I don't feel as though its the 'best' artform, but its the rawest to me - the one that can elicit emotion most directly. Music to me feels closer to a sensation than other forms, like eating something, or being touched, not like interpreting a story. I have a complicated relationship to writing music, but mostly it is one of my favorite things to do, and I don't do it as much as I used to, so I miss it sometimes. I found an old piece of music I did called 'music for

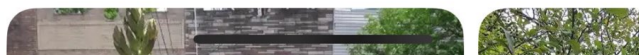
wandering' right when I moved to Athens, which was the result of giving myself 2 weeks to write an hour of music. I listened back to it and liked it, so I decided to do the same now, except I only had like 6 days this time (and a much more busy life than my first empty days in Athens). It felt really good to come home after the events of the day and get deep into writing. Everything was pretty rushed, I ended up with 5 pieces of music comprising the hour. I focused on keeping things simple and minimal, and allowed myself to leave in mistakes, or bad decisions, because I think that's in the spirit

THE WANDER

Starting location is “public place”
Which is a fun name for tiny park



Public Place



Today's wander is simple - it is intended for 2 people

The Rules are as follows:

- No Talking
- Turn your phone to silent, don't open it
- The wander will last exactly 1 hour, which is the length of The music piece I've prepared, which we will listen to together
- watch for cars, and signal to others for cars etc.
- The music piece has 5 distinct sections, this will dictate who is leading
- Person A is the person whose name comes first in the alphabetical order

- For section 1, there is no leader - decide together by pointing, one direction to go, and follow that direction straight for the whole first section
- For sections 2, 3, 4, and 5 - switch off between person A and B leading (A leads 2, B leads 3, etc.)
- The leader of the wander walks where they feel like. We are not collectively trying to reach any destination, or go to any place. The leader walks wherever their curiosity brings them. There are no rules or limits about where the leader can or can't go

On wandering today:

In the usual poem I reference “*Think of your eyes like a camera. This moment a scene in a film*” which mostly comes from what I find myself doing on a wander. There’s something very special about that. It’s the feeling of being entirely inside of the bubble, observing the world as a scene, in which you’re completely immersed, but in the role of a spectator, hunting for each detail of that which unfolds in front of you - searching for the beautiful and interesting. I like to imagine that what I’m seeing is placed before me by someone - not a god but a director, who has picked this moment for me to study

On wandering with 2 people:

I mostly wander alone - It's very much an escape for me. But I also love wandering with another person - your wandering styles are most clear here. When you're alone you don't even notice them because there's nothing else, and in a group they sort of blend and merge, but with 2 people I can feel the way that you wander, and you me. It's like playing music or having sex, but much much more subtle. There's minuscule ways in which we wander differently, things neither of us will notice, but that are a part of who we are, how we move through the world - which things draw us, how we walk, how we look